



Logline

When a preacher's daughter elopes with a reformed felon, she uncovers a ledger that proves her own father framed him—and that their families have been bound by a thirty-year-old secret affair. To save her husband, she must burn down the pulpit she was raised to revere.

Tone

Southern Gothic Romance, Financial Noir Thriller, High-Stakes Drama

Theme

Redemption, Betrayal, Family Secrets, Faith vs. Hypocrisy

Pitch

Sinner & Saints is a gripping drama that blends the emotional depth of a romance with the tension of a financial thriller. Set against the backdrop of a small-town church community, the series delves into the complexities of love, loyalty, and redemption. Danielle Cross, a preacher's daughter, defies her family's expectations by marrying Malik Hayes, a reformed ex-con. As their marriage is threatened by the dark secrets of her own family, Danielle must confront the truth and decide whether to uphold the faith she was raised with or stand by the man she loves.

Detailed Synopsis

Act 1 – Elopement (0-15 min)

Danielle Cross, a seemingly perfect preacher's daughter, feels suffocated by the high expectations of her father's church. She secretly elopes with Malik Hayes, a charming and hardworking reformed felon. Their small, intimate wedding is filled with hope, but the fallout is immediate. Pastor Gabriel Cross and First Lady Etta Cross are devastated and furious, and the church community is abuzz with gossip. Danielle feels isolated but stands by Malik.

Act 2 – Setup Exposed (15-30 min)

Malik starts a new job, proving his commitment to a clean life, but an "accident" occurs—he is involved in a seemingly random incident that makes him look suspicious. The police get involved, and his past record puts him under scrutiny. Danielle begins to suspect the "accident" isn't random and notices inconsistencies in her father's behavior.

Act 3 – Blood Ledger (30-45 min)

Danielle investigates the "accident" and stumbles upon a hidden ledger at the church, exposing a trail of blackmail, fraud, and betrayal orchestrated by her father. The ledger confirms his role in Malik's setup and reveals other morally dubious acts. The revelation creates a crisis within the church and the community.

Act 4 – Mother's Confession (45-60 min)

Danielle confronts her mother, Etta, who eventually breaks down and confesses to an affair with Malik's now-dead father. This shocking revelation explains Etta's deep-seated prejudice against Malik and her attempts to keep him away from Danielle.

Act 5 – Sunday Showdown (60-75 min)

Pastor Gabriel Cross, cornered, attempts to flee or deny everything. The community is in shock and upheaval. Danielle makes a public stand, choosing to reveal the truth, even if it means destroying her family's reputation, to save Malik and uphold justice.

Act 6 – Exodus & Ashes (75-90 min)

The church faces an uncertain future, and Pastor Gabriel Cross potentially faces legal repercussions. Etta grapples with her past and the consequences of her choices. Danielle and Malik, their love tested and proven, look towards a new, uncertain but hopeful future together, free from the shadows of the past.

Character Breakdown

- Danielle Cross: 28, choir-director perfect on Sunday, true-crime-podcast binger by night. Fluent in scripture and spreadsheets.
- Malik Hayes: 30, ex-army medic who served time for covering up a field-medical drug ring. The only man who's ever apologized to her without expecting absolution.
- First Lady Etta Cross: 55, Instagram-famous #PastorsWife. Posts daily devotionals while privately running a shell nonprofit that launders tithe money.
- Pastor Gabriel Cross: 60, velvet-voiced, owns four suits and one burner phone.

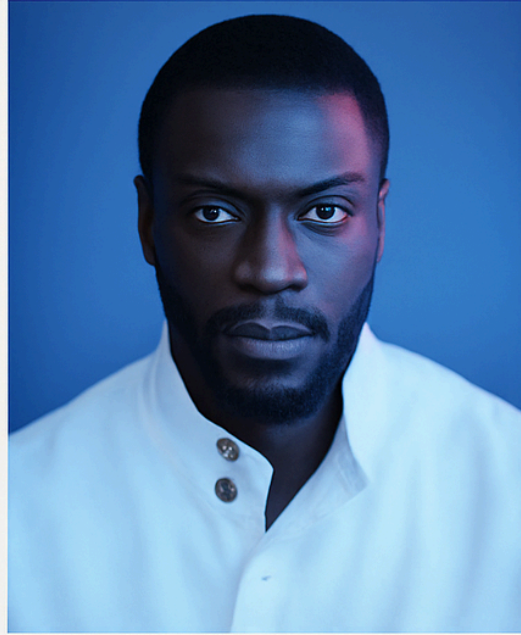
Talent Suggestions

- Danielle Cross: Kiersey Clemons
- Malik Hayes: Aldis Hodge
- First Lady Etta Cross: Regina King
- Pastor Gabriel Cross: Lance Gross

SINNER & SAINTS



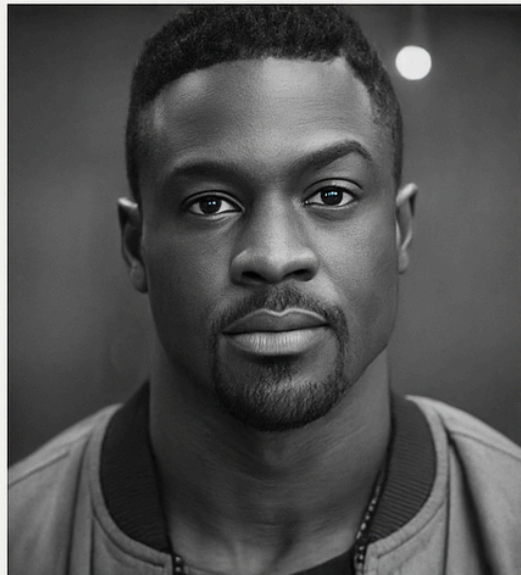
DANIELLE CROSS
KIERSEY CLEMONS



MALIK HAYES
ALDIS HODGE



FIRST LADY
ETTA CROSS
REGINA KING



PASTOR GABRIEL
CROSS
LANCE GROSS

Director Match Suggestions

- Ava DuVernay
- Barry Jenkins
- Dee Rees

Lookbook or Mood Reel References

- Film: "The Beguiled" (2017)
- Series: "Ozark" (Netflix)
- Visual Style: Southern Gothic with a modern twist, blending naturalistic lighting with dark, moody tones.

Marketing Hooks & Promo-Ready Taglines

- "Love can't erase the past, but it can expose the truth."
- "In a world of sinners and saints, who can you trust?"
- "When faith fails, love prevails."

Target Audience & Market

- Core Audience: Women aged 25-45, fans of Lifetime, OWN, and BET dramas.
- Market Appeal: High-stakes drama with a strong female lead, complex family dynamics, and a gripping mystery.

Why It Sells

- Timely Themes: Explores relevant issues of faith, hypocrisy, and redemption.
- Compelling Characters: Strong, relatable characters with depth and complexity.
- Unique Setting: A small-town church community with dark secrets.
- Market Demand: Aligns with current trends in high-stakes dramas and Southern Gothic storytelling.

Comparable Films & Series

- "Ozark" (Netflix)
- "The Beguiled" (2017)
- "Big Little Lies" (HBO)

Production Value

- High-Quality Cinematography: Cinematic visuals with a focus on Southern Gothic aesthetics.
- Strong Casting: Talented ensemble cast with A-list actors.
- Engaging Storytelling: Tight, well-paced narrative with unexpected twists and turns.

Story & Hook – Why This Story Matters Now

Sinner & Saints tackles the timeless themes of love, loyalty, and redemption, set against the backdrop of a small-town church community. It explores the complexities of faith and hypocrisy, making it a relevant and compelling story for today's audiences. The series offers a fresh take on the Southern Gothic genre, blending romance, suspense, and family drama to create a gripping narrative that keeps viewers on the edge of their seats.

Demographics

- Age: 25-45
- Gender: Primarily female, with a strong appeal to male viewers as well.
- Interests: Drama, Mystery, Romance, Faith-Based Stories

Marketability

- Strong Female Lead: Empowered, relatable protagonist.
- Complex Family Dynamics: Multi-generational storytelling with deep emotional stakes.
- Gripping Mystery: High-stakes plot with unexpected twists and turns.
- Relevant Themes: Faith, redemption, and the search for truth.

This comprehensive pitch document is designed to grab the attention of decision-makers by highlighting the unique selling points of Sinner & Saints and its alignment with current trends and audience interests.